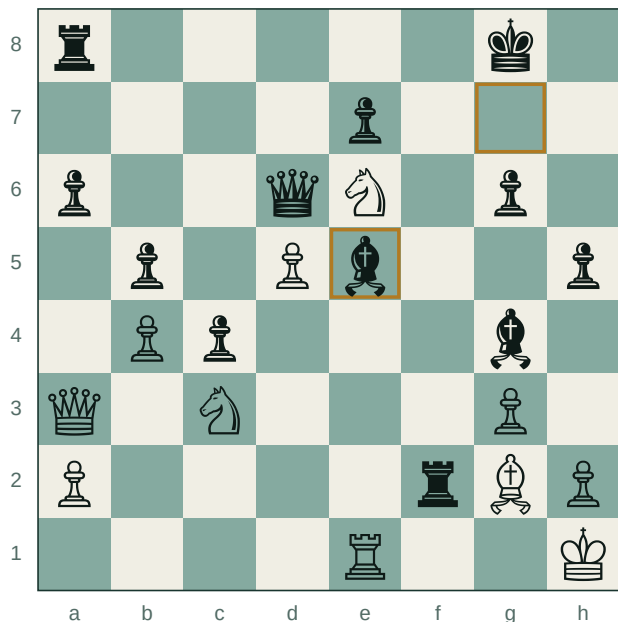


Discovered attacks: White, move 31

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 30...Be5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Ne4 Qb6 32. Nxf2 Qxf2 33. Rxe5 Qd2 34. Qe3

31.Ne4 The knight moves from c3 to e4. From e4 it attacks queen on d6 and rook on f2. Recorded reply: **31...Qb6**.

32.Nxf2 The knight captures the rook on f2. The changed line means the rook on e1 attacks the bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **32...Qxf2**.

33.Rxe5 The rook captures the bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **33...Qd2**.

34.Qe3 The queen moves from a3 to e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.